PART 1 · MODULE A

Design foundations

The principles behind every good design, explained first in simple words.

A1. Colour theory

A colour has three properties: hue (the colour), saturation (how strong) and value (how light). Complementary colours sit opposite on the wheel and create contrast; analogous colours sit side by side and feel calm.

A2. Contrast and accessibility

Text must be readable. The WCAG AA guideline asks for a contrast ratio of at least 4.5:1 for normal text and 3:1 for large text. Check every text colour pair, not only the brand colours.

PYTHON

```
from contrast import contrast_ratio, passes_aa
print(contrast_ratio("#1D1640", "#FFFFFF"))   # 16.92 : passes
print(passes_aa("#9CA3AF", "#FFFFFF"))        # False : too light for body text
```

A3. Typography

Choose one or two typefaces. Keep body text at 16 px or more on screens, with a line height near 1.5. Use a clear scale (for example 14, 16, 20, 28, 40) rather than random sizes.

A4. Composition, alignment, spacing and grids

Align elements to a common edge. Use a spacing scale (8, 16, 24, 32). A 12-column grid on desktop and a 4-column grid on phones keeps layouts consistent.

A5. Visual hierarchy

The viewer should see the most important thing first, then the next, then the detail. Size, weight, colour and space create the order. Test by squinting at the screen: the hierarchy should still read.

A6. Design psychology and visual storytelling

People scan before they read. Faces, arrows and contrast draw attention. A story has a problem, a turn and a result; a good layout guides the eye through the same sequence.

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